HD Point, report, Funding, Nigeria, 2026-10-30

Talent Nation raises pre-seed round to train one million African AI engineers

Key figures

Figure	Value	Basis	Claim
Learn2Earn applications	63,000 applications	**Company says**	c8

What was reported

1. Talent Nation, a startup founded by Nigerian serial entrepreneur Iyinoluwa Aboyeji and South African-born entrepreneur Kesiah Valkin, has raised an undisclosed pre-seed round. **Verified** c1
2. It aims to train and deploy one million AI engineers from Africa into businesses worldwide over the next decade. **Verified** c2
3. The round was co-led by Enza Capital and London-based LocalGlobe, with participation from Future Africa, Kaleo Ventures, Ajim Capital, Solving.org and Accelerate Africa. **Verified** c3
4. Through its Learn2Earn academy, Talent Nation trains, certifies and deploys engineers into organisations that want to build and manage their own AI capabilities. **Verified** c4
5. Aboyeji, the executive chairman, co-founded Andela and Flutterwave, according to Semafor. **Verified** c5
6. The company has not disclosed the size of the round or a detailed timetable for reaching its target. **Verified** c6
7. Aboyeji says Talent Nation wants to make certified AI engineering talent accessible to organisations at a fraction of the cost of hiring from frontier AI labs or traditional consulting firms. **Company says** c7
8. Aboyeji told Semafor that Learn2Earn received 63,000 applications, and fewer than 3% were selected for training on multiple campuses. **Company says** c8
9. Aboyeji told Semafor that most developers from the training programmes will be African, though he does not want to constrain the company to that. **Company says** c9
10. The venture mirrors Andela, which Aboyeji launched in 2014 and which trained a generation of software engineers in six African countries, according to Semafor. **Verified** c10

11. Companies are adopting AI quickly, but many struggle to find engineers who can build and maintain reliable systems around AI models, according to TechAwk NG. **Verified** `c11`

How well sourced is this?

8 of 11 claims are supported by an independent source. 3 come from the company itself and have not been independently checked.

Source	Claims	Basis
https://techmoran.com/2026/10/28/talent-nation-raises-pre-seed-funding-to-train-1-million-african-ai-engineers/	c1, c2, c3, c4, c6, c7	Verified, Company says
https://www.semafor.com/article/10/28/2026/nigerian-serial-tech-founder-launches-ai-startup	c5, c8, c9, c10	Verified, Company says
https://www.techawkng.com/2026/10/28/talent-nation-raises-pre-seed-for-african-ai-engineers/	c11	Verified

About this report

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